

Expectations for Week 5 Proposals

- Your team can demonstrate you have access to people, and the context/location, of your chosen domain of human activity
- You have engaged users (plural! more is better) who are domain owners (i.e. know more about your domain than you do). When you are asked about what you are doing and why, you can refer to some of the things you have discovered about your users/domain.
- You have identified relevant peer-reviewed research, and can identify insights and/or design opportunities from what you have learned
- You are working towards designing something that is original, thoughtful, interesting, and social & mobile (i.e. collaborative and context-sensitive). You have done this with the use of design methods, co-design methods, and other generative activities.
- You have had more than one idea.
- You have a thoughtful and realistic plan of how you will use methods (design methods and investigation methods) to design, prototype, evaluate over the coming weeks.
- What you present at the tradeshow in Week 12 will not be what you propose on Tuesday.

3. Prepare the Design Proposal Presentation

10 minutes + Q&A. You're still narrowing down between concepts — explain what's still in contention and how you'll narrow it.

Cover:

1. Your team and its combined strengths (not individual bios)
2. The domain/problem space, backed by your research
3. Your design opportunity and initial concepts, linked to research and any interviews/observations
4. Your intended audience — go beyond demographics: their skills, values, workflows, priorities
5. A critique of existing solutions in this space and how yours differs
6. Your plan of work — what you still need to find out and how you'll investigate it

Slides: exactly 5, ~2 minutes each

- Slide 1: Team intro & strengths (Isabelle)
- Slide 2: Domain/problem space
- Slides 3: concepts, research, prior attempts (order flexible)
- Slide 4: Design opportunity, audience (trent)
- Slide 5: Plan of work & methods (natasha)

How You'll Be Assessed (Pass/Fail)

- Whole team present and involved in delivering the presentation
- Clear, specific description of the domain/problem space
- Clear description of the design concept, its audience, and how it fits the domain and course
- The concept is creative, social & contextual, and user-focused
- Sources are used well to support the domain, concept, and course context
- The plan of work realistically covers what's needed to build a proof-of-concept prototype
- Confident, well-timed delivery with good visual support

*Note: **Proof-of-concept prototype** = an advanced prototype balancing simulation and real functionality — users can meaningfully interact with the key parts of the concept, while still getting a sense of the whole.*

Slide 5: Plan of work & methods (natasha)

1. [What we know / What we need to know]

"We already know a few things from our research: non-judgmental, robot-based practice drives more engagement than traditional teacher-led instruction, especially for people afraid of making mistakes. But we also know rehearsed fluency breaks down the moment real social pressure kicks in — and that buddy pairing helps reduce onboarding friction generally.

2. What we don't know yet is whether that holds true specifically in a workplace — whether robot-plus-app is actually better than robot alone, whether our nudges will feel helpful or intrusive, and where exactly 'helpful support' turns into a crutch."

3. [Interviews]

"To answer that, we're interviewing two linked groups: workers who don't yet know the workplace language, about their real communication struggles and what support they'd actually want — and the workers and mentors who currently support them, to understand that informal teaching burden and where it feels uneven."

4. [Concept validation]

"From there, we run a concept validation session — presenting both the robot-only and robot-plus-app framing to participants, and measuring which one actually feels more useful and natural. That's what locks our final direction before we build anything."

5. [Wizard-of-Oz test]

"Before we build the app itself, we test the core mechanic with a Wizard-of-Oz approach — manually sending someone a phrase suggestion five minutes before a meeting, just like the app would, to see if the timing actually feels helpful rather than intrusive."

6. [Proof of concept]

"That informs our proof-of-concept: we build out the core interaction based on what testing tells us matters most, and simulate everything secondary — so a user can genuinely interact with the key part of the system, while still getting a sense of the whole."

7. [Timeline]

"All of this runs across the next seven weeks — interviews and concept lock in weeks five and six, Wizard-of-Oz testing into week seven, building through the interim presentation in week nine, then refining from feedback and finalising for our final presentation in week twelve."

